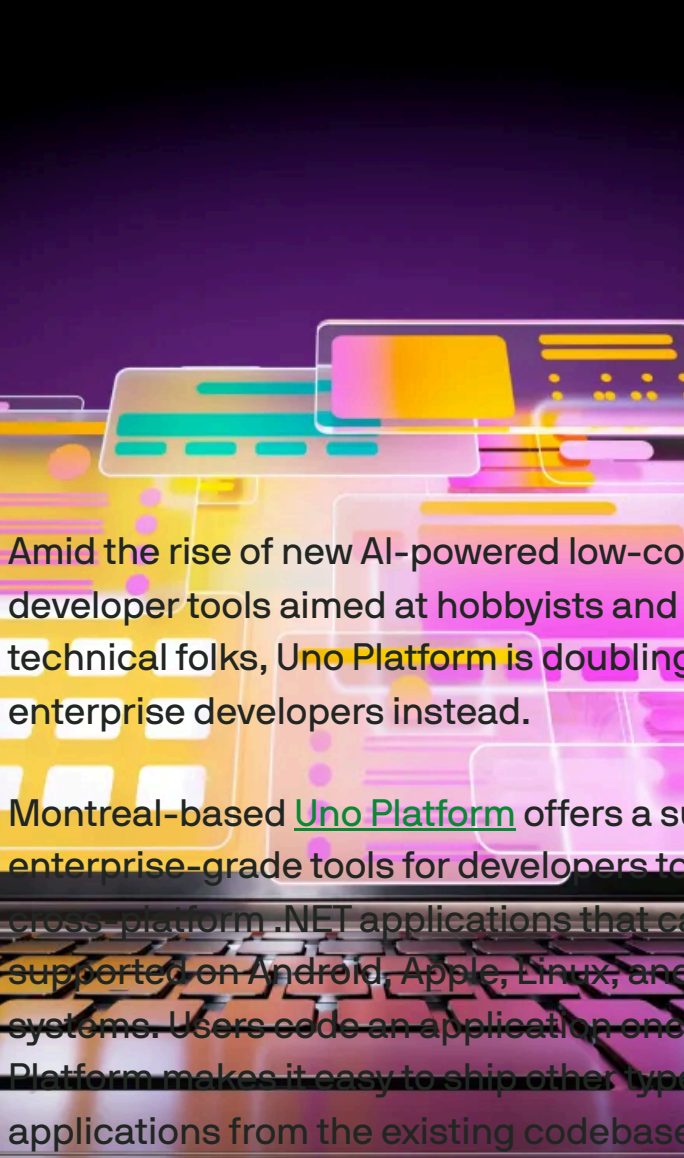


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ENTERPRISE



In a world of vibe coding startups, Uno Platform is targeting enterprise developers



Amid the rise of new AI-powered low-code developer tools aimed at hobbyists and non-technical folks, [Uno Platform](#) is doubling down on enterprise developers instead.

Montreal-based [Uno Platform](#) offers a suite of enterprise-grade tools for developers to build cross-platform .NET applications that can be supported on Android, Apple, Linux, and Windows systems. Users code an application once and Uno Platform makes it easy to ship other types of applications from the existing codebase.

“If you’re coding something once and it works on five different platforms on desktop, web, and mobile, you’re getting 5x the productivity already,” Uno Platform co-founder and CEO Francois Tanguay told TechCrunch.

Uno Platform is not the only app developer tool platform available, but Tanguay thinks it stands out in a market flooded by vibe coding platforms like [Lovable](#) and [Cursor](#). For Tanguay, enterprise developers should have access to productivity tools too.

“Everything we are shipping hasn’t been done before and we like we have a clear road map in terms of how we can add those extra capabilities [to] make everybody 10x faster,” Tanguay said. “Nobody’s capturing that market yet in the enterprise space.”

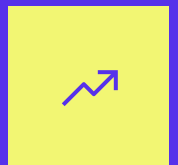
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The 2-year-old startup's enterprise focus has attracted customers and investors. Uno Platform just raised a C\$3.5 million (\$2.54 million) seed funding round co-led by AQC Capital and Desjardins Capital, with participation from Scott Hanselman, the vice president of Microsoft's developer community, in addition to other angel investors.

The capital will help Uno roll out its premium tooling tier, Uno Platform Studio, and new feature, "Hot Design" which allows developers to pause a running application and change its user interface in real time.

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From in-house tools to spinout

Tanguay said they wanted to build Uno Platform to be as seamless to use and helpful as working with a consulting agency, which is exactly how the company got started in the first place.

Tanguay founded [Nventive](#) in 2008 as a consulting agency to build apps for companies right as apps were becoming the next hot technology. After a few years, Nventive started developing the suite of tools that eventually became Uno Platform because the agency was looking for ways to make itself more efficient, Tanguay said.

Nventive launched Uno Platform as an open source toolbox in 2018. The open source community could help the agency keep up with frequently changing operating systems that were constantly releasing new versions that required Uno Platform to tweak its offerings.

“We have over a hundred million downloads of the platform, something we wouldn’t have been able to do just by ourselves,” Tanguay said. “It was really betting on the open source, as a community, to help grow that initiative and bet that others would see the same value in having access to a toolbox like this.”

Tanguay was right and the company has more than 300 open source contributors. Nventive decided to fully spin out the tool box and created Uno Platform in 2023. Since then, the company has started working with enterprise customers, including Toyota, Microsoft, and TradeZero, among others.

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Rebecca Szkutak

Senior Reporter, Venture | [in](#)

Becca is a senior writer at TechCrunch that covers venture capital trends and startups. She previously covered the...

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IMAGE CREDITS: FIRECRAWL

STARTUPS

AI crawler Firecrawl raises \$14.5M, is still looking to hire agents as employees

Julie Bort — 4:00 AM PDT · August 19, 2025

Firecrawl’s co-founder and CEO Caleb Pepper knew the exact moment he found the investor to lead his Series A.

He was in a coffee meeting with Nexus Venture Partner’s Abhishek Sharma at the Blue Bottle in San Francisco’s South Park (a favorite VC haunt). While describing the future of the company, he was gesturing so animatedly that his chair tipped over.

“I actually fell out of my chair. And Abhishek, as a great Investor does, caught the chair and me as I was falling,” Pepper described with a laugh. That felt like a symbol for how the founder/investor relationship is supposed to work. “I think that was a clear signal that he was the right partner.”

On Tuesday, Firecrawl announced a Series A led by Nexus with participation from Shopify CEO Tobias Lütke and existing investor Y Combinator.

Firecrawl offers a popular open-source web crawler for developers and AI agents, with a commercially supported version available through API. It’s used by 350,000 developers, has nearly [50,000 stars](#) on GitHub and its notable customers include Shopify, Replit, and Zapier as well as “some of the largest hedge funds in the world,” Pepper told TechCrunch. And, he says, the company is already profitable.

The startup also just released an API that supports search and will soon add support for natural language prompts, as co-founder and CTO Nicolas Silberstein Camara noted.

Pepper, who co-founded Firecrawl in 2022 with Camara and CMO Eric Ciarla, said gaining Lütke as an investor was “the best kind of validation.”

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They landed him through a gutsy email after discovering the Shopify founder had signed up to try their product through their self-service portal.

“We saw his email come in,” Pfeffer said. The Firecrawl crew immediately emailed him to welcome him as a customer, but got no response. Two months later, some Shopify folks contacted Firecrawl for an enterprise contract. So Pfeffer took his shot and emailed Lütke again, mentioning they'd love for him to participate in their upcoming round.

This time, Lütke responded with compliments about their product. He was in.

While AI web crawlers have [a somewhat dubious reputation these days](#), mostly due to bad actors [that ignore robot.txt files](#), they are also a necessary part of the burgeoning AI world. AI trains on the web, [agents need to access web pages to perform their duties](#), and enterprises need personalized crawlers to consume their own websites for training and operations.

The Firecrawl founders also hope to help address the frustrating parts of their industry. They are working on tools to help website owners, publishers, and other content creators “get paid when AI uses their content. We think this is the way it should be,” Peffer said.

While there have been lots of efforts around this idea from big names like [Adobe and Getty](#) as well as startups [like Bria](#), [Calliope Networks](#), and others, Peffer feels that Firecrawl has an edge because it’s already working with those who are scraping data.

“We already have one side of the marketplace,” he said. “What we want to do is just connect that side of the marketplace to the website owners, the publishers.”

Interestingly, Firecrawl also went viral a few months ago for reasons that have little to do with their open source tool. They had posted an [ad to the YC job board looking to hire an AI agent as an employee for a \\$15,000 salary](#) – perhaps the first job ad for an agent employee, ever.

That job search didn’t yield an agent worth hiring, so Firecrawled upped the budget to up [\\$1 million to hire several agents and the developers who built them, and tried again](#). Applicants flooded in, Peffer said, but the company hasn’t yet hired any. The founders realized that evaluating and managing wanna-be agent employees is a job in itself. So now they are looking for an AI chief of staff.

Firecrawl’s Peffer will [be on stage at Disrupt in October](#) to discuss all that he’s learned in a session that covers the pros and cons of hiring AI agents as early employees.



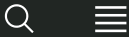
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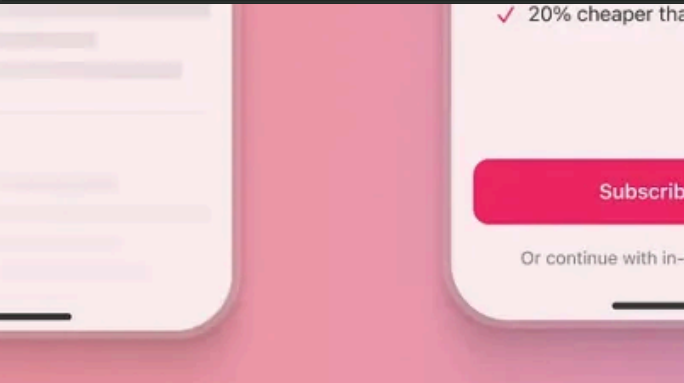
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IOS

Sarah Perez — 10:16 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

Newsletter subscription platform Substack will begin taking advantage of an option on the U.S. App Store that allows users to make purchases outside of Apple's in-app purchasing system. This functionality is permitted by a [change to the App Store's rules in May](#), as a result of [Epic Games' antitrust lawsuit](#) against the tech giant.

Since then, a number of top apps have moved to offer in-app purchase links that point to their own websites, including [Spotify](#), [Patreon](#), and the [Amazon Kindle](#) app, among others.

In Substack's case, support for external payments will benefit both the company, which no longer has to pay the App Store a commission on those web sales, and consumers, who will have access to reduced pricing. Meanwhile, Substack creators will be able to offer their readers the option of whether they want the convenience of Apple's in-app payments system (IAP) or the web payment option, which is now accessible without having to leave the app.

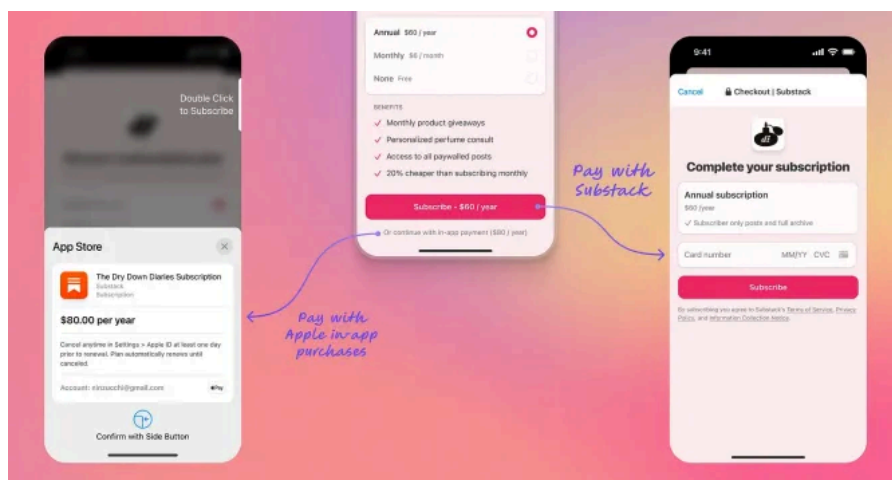


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

Substack explains it will automatically adjust its customers' iOS app price higher to account for Apple's fees, allowing creators to take home the same amount of money as a web subscription. However, Substack writers can disable this feature if they choose. (Substack will continue to take its own

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APPS



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Sarah Perez - 6 hours ago

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OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta - 12 hours ago

10% fee based on the web subscription price, as before.)

The company said in its blog post that it's also offering its writers "migration tools." We originally reported that these could help migrate users from one payments platform to another, but Substack reached out to correct this. Instead, it said that the tools are meant to help creators access billing information for Apple-managed subscriptions if they ever leave the platform.

Currently, more than 30,000 publications on the platform have in-app purchases enabled; Substack says early tests of the expanded set of payment options have driven a boost in paid sign-ups. It did not, however, share specific numbers related to this.

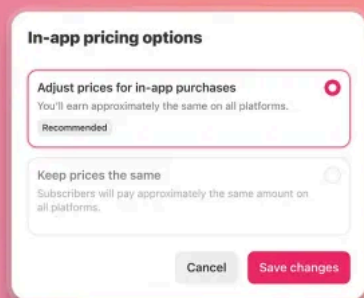


IMAGE CREDITS: SUBSTACK

The public launch of the external payments option will only impact new Substack subscriptions. Substack writers don't have to take any action unless they want to lower the prices for those using Apple's payments system.

Per Apple's App Store rules, fully opting out of offering IAP is not allowed.

While the changes impact the Substack app in the U.S., the company says it's still evaluating if it makes sense to switch to the more complex rules Apple

offers in the EU and U.K. for developers who want to forgo IAP.

Updated after publication to correct and clarify how the migration tools work.

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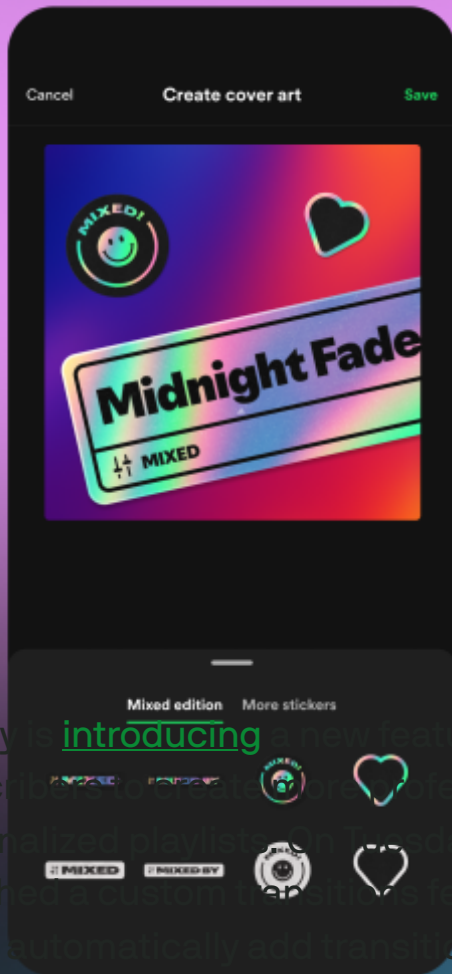
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Spotify's latest feature lets you add your own transitions to playlists

Sarah Perez — 3:00 AM PDT · August 19, 2025

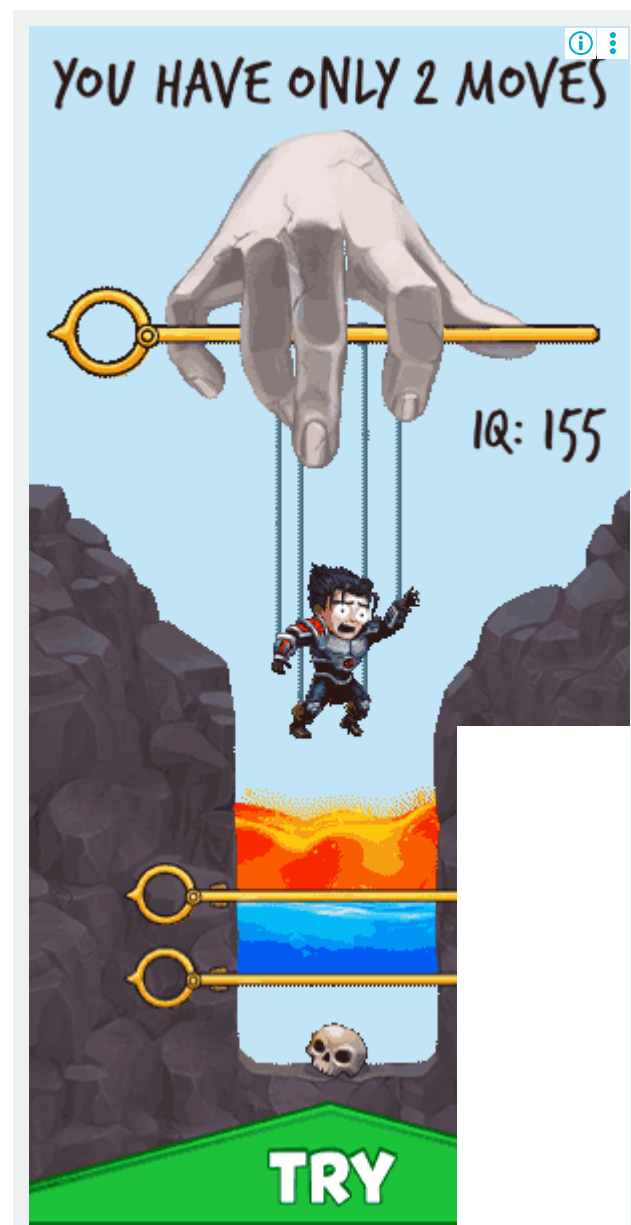


Spotify is **introducing** a new feature that allows subscribers to add their own transitions to professional, personalized playlists. On Friday, the company launched a custom Spotify feature that lets you either automatically add transitions between a playlist's tracks or customize your own using preset options like fade, rise, or blend, along with other options.

IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

To use the feature, open any playlist and select “Mix” from the toolbar to begin editing. While customizing the track with different transition styles, you can also adjust settings for things like the volume, EQ, and effects, and use the waveform and beat data to find the best spot in each track to begin the transition.

Spotify notes that it will automatically display the key and the beats per minute for each track, to make it easier for novice audio mixers to get started.



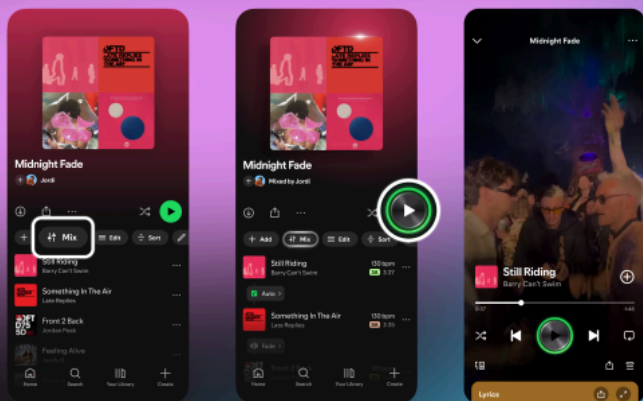


IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

The new options are designed to appeal to playlist experts and other music fans, who have collectively created nearly 9 billion playlists on Spotify’s platform to date.

The rollout complements other updates Spotify has launched over the past year that give users more control over their listening experience, the company says, like the tools to [add, sort, and edit playlists](#), [customize the genre of the Discover Weekly](#) playlist, [snooze tracks](#), [make voice requests to the AI DJ](#), and more. It also allows Spotify to compete with Apple Music’s [upcoming](#) AutoMix feature, which is currently live in the iOS 26 developer beta, and claims to let you mix “like a DJ.”

Premium subscribers with access to the transitions feature will also be able to save and share the playlist with other friends on social media or even invite other subscribers to collaborate on a mixed playlist.

The mix can be toggled on and off at any time by pressing the “mix” option, allowing you to turn your playlist back to the more traditional kind when the party or gym workout (or wherever else you’re streaming the mix) has ended.

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IMAGE CREDITS: SPOTIFY

The company recommends that mixing works best with music that's already been produced for seamless transitions, like house and techno, which tend to blend more easily.

Like other playlists, the mixes can be further [customized using your own cover art](#) along with newly added stickers and labels made just for mixed playlists.

Custom transitions in playlists are available starting today for the majority of eligible Premium users worldwide. (The company says some markets in the APAC region will still need to wait for the addition.)

The feature is rolling out gradually to users who have updated their Spotify app for iOS or Android.

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